The Box at Gate 3

A Halloween story · A1 · present simple



WORDS

dark – tmavý, tma
face – obličej
move – hýbat se
scary – strašidelný
pumpkin – dýně
laugh – smát se
quiet – tichý
candle – svíčka
behind – za

It is 31 October. It is Halloween. It is 22:00 and it is dark.

Petra is a driver. She drives Truck 5. She doesn't like Halloween. She doesn't watch scary films, and she doesn't like dark warehouses.

Tonight Petra brings brake parts to the Toyota warehouse. Gate 1 is closed, so she uses Gate 3. The warehouse is very quiet. The lights aren't on. Nobody is here.

Petra unloads the pallets. Then she stops. There is a big box next to the door. It isn't on her list.

"Is this box for Toyota?" she asks. Nobody answers.

The box has a face: two big eyes and a big smile. There is a light in the eyes. It is orange.

Petra calls Jan.
"Jan, there is a box at Gate 3. It has a face. Does it have an order number?"
"No, it doesn't," Jan says. "I don't send boxes with faces."
"Is it from the Parts Centre?"
"No, it isn't. Petra… does the face move?"

Petra looks. The face doesn't move. But the light in the eyes moves.

Petra opens the box. Inside, there is a big orange pumpkin. It has a face, and there is a candle in it. Next to the pumpkin there is a card:

> ***"Happy Halloween, Petra! From Marek."***

Petra laughs. Marek isn't ill tonight. He isn't at home. He is behind the forklift!

"Do you like it?" Marek asks.
"No, I don't," Petra says. Then she smiles. "OK. Yes, I do. A little."



Did you know?

A pumpkin with a face and a candle is a **jack-o'-lantern**. The first jack-o'-lanterns are from Ireland, and they aren't pumpkins. They are **turnips** (tuřín)! Pumpkins come from America.

1 · Short answers

Answer with *Yes, she does. / No, it isn't...*

1 Does Petra like Halloween? ***No, she doesn't.***

2 Is the warehouse quiet? ***Yes, it is.***

3 Does Petra use Gate 1? ***No, she doesn't. (She uses Gate 3.)***

4 Does the box have an order number? ***No, it doesn't.***

5 Is Marek ill tonight? ***No, he isn't.***

6 Does Petra like the pumpkin? ***Yes, she does. (A little!)***

2 · Understand the story

Answer the questions. Short answers are OK: *At 22:00.*

7 What time is it? ***It's 22:00.***

8 What does Petra drive? ***She drives Truck 5.***

9 What does Petra bring to the warehouse? ***She brings brake parts.***

10 Which gate does she use? ***She uses Gate 3.***

11 Where is the box? ***It's next to the door.***

12 Who does Petra call? ***She calls Jan.***

13 What is in the box? ***A pumpkin with a face and a candle.***

14 Who is behind the forklift? ***Marek is behind the forklift.***

3 · Make it true

The sentence is wrong. Write the negative + the true sentence.
Example: Petra likes Halloween. → She doesn't like Halloween.

15 Petra watches scary films.

She doesn't watch scary films.

16 Petra drives Truck 3.

She doesn't drive Truck 3. She drives Truck 5.

17 Petra brings tyres.

She doesn't bring tyres. She brings brake parts.

18 Gate 3 is closed.

Gate 3 isn't closed. Gate 1 is closed.

19 The lights are on.

The lights aren't on.

20 The box is from the Parts Centre.

It isn't from the Parts Centre. It's from Marek.

21 Jan sends boxes with faces.

Jan doesn't send boxes with faces.

22 The face moves.

The face doesn't move. The light moves.

23 Marek is at home.

Marek isn't at home. He's behind the forklift.

💬 **Your turn** Do you like Halloween? · Do you have a pumpkin at home? · Do you watch scary films?

How to use it (15–20 min)

1. You read the story aloud once. He only listens. Then he reads it aloud. · 2. Go through the words box first if he needs it.
3. Exercises 1 and 3: **he says it first, then writes it.** In 3 he must use the negative *and* the true sentence. · 4. In Exercise 2 accept short answers (*At 22:00. / Jan.*).
5. Finish with 💬 *Your turn*: free talk, don't correct small mistakes. · Grammar: only present simple (be + do/does), nothing new.